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CAPIZ STATE UNIVERSITY
PONTEVEDRA CAMPUS
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Project **SPACE** (*Solo Parents Acknowledgement, Capacity-building, and Empowerment*)

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RATIONALE:

The Philippines' classification as a developing country, as established by the International Monetary Fund's World Economic Outlook Database in October 2018, signifies a nation in the midst of a transformative journey toward economic progress and improved social welfare. This classification reflects the acknowledgment that there remains considerable work to be done by the government and the citizenry to uplift the lives of those in vulnerable and marginalized groups within the nation. While the government has made commendable efforts to address the needs of these marginalized groups through the enactment of laws and the establishment of dedicated offices, a notable deficiency in support for Solo Parents has come to the forefront.

The pressing reality confronting Solo Parents unveils a myriad of formidable challenges. These challenges encompass enduring physical, emotional, and mental exhaustion, primarily stemming from the arduous demands of single parenthood. The adverse consequences of this fatigue ripple through various aspects of their lives, affecting personal well-being, productivity, relationships, and family dynamics.

Research studies conducted by Hashim et al. (2015), W. Jiumpanyarach (2011), and Kotwal & Prabhakar (2009) substantiate the assertion that Solo Parents confront not only financial obstacles but also grapple with formidable social and emotional stressors. These findings underscore the multifaceted nature of the difficulties faced by Solo Parents.

Additionally, Dr. Pet Roana B. Batacandolo's study conducted in 2019 has pinpointed a critical issue within the existing legal framework. Despite the presence of legal provisions, such as the Solo Parent's Welfare Act (RA 8972/RA 11861), a lack of awareness among Solo Parents regarding their entitlements under this law serves as a major impediment. This deficiency in awareness underscores the urgent necessity to enhance information dissemination and the effective implementation of the law to benefit Solo Parents.



In response to these challenges, Project SPACE has been conceived. This initiative seeks to foster a more supportive environment for Solo Parents by gathering and empowering especially indigent Solo Parents. It does so through a multifaceted approach, which includes informative seminars on R.A. 8972/11861, the formulation of a Constitution and By-Laws, the provision of psycho-social and emotional support, and offering skills training through the training needs assessment survey to enhance financial stability and overall empowerment. The launch of this remarkable initiative in the municipality of Pontevedra, in collaboration with the local government's Office of the MSWD, demonstrates a tangible commitment to addressing the unique needs of Solo Parents and helping them overcome the multifarious challenges they face.

OBJECTIVES

The primary goal of Project SPACE is to empower Solo Parents and help increase their income. This reflects a commitment to improving the socio-economic well-being of Solo Parents in the Philippines.

Specifically, the project aims:

1. to make Solo Parents more aware of the laws concerning their welfare and ensure that they are informed about their rights and benefits;
2. to provide seminars and support to improve the emotional and mental well-being of Solo Parents, providing them with essential coping tools; and
3. to provide technical assistance to Solo Parents, enabling them to enhance their skills for income generation, directly addressing the financial challenges they face.

PROJECT DESCRIPTION:

Project SPACE was implemented on the 26 barangays in Pontevedra, Capiz with the registered Solo Parents as the target beneficiaries. The beneficiaries were chosen from these two criteria: Indigent and Needy. The Project is implemented by CapSU Pontevedra and LGU Pontevedra under the **KaLaPIT (Kabuy-anan, Ika-ayong Lawas, Panguma, Ihibalo, Teknolohiya) Program** by which both institutions are under a memorandum of agreement. The College of Management spearheads the project under its MANGGAD (**Management of Assets and Natural resources for Good Governance And Development**) program. The project was launched in April 2022 and is expected to end in June 2025.

The project consists of three phases. Phase I, set to conclude in the fourth quarter of 2023, focuses on disseminating information about RA 8972/RA 11861, crafting the Constitution and By-Laws, establishing associations/federations, DOLE registration, and LGU accreditation, including an updated master list. Phase II emphasizes seminars and workshops aimed at enhancing the emotional and mental well-being of Solo Parents, while Phase III involves providing technical assistance to improve their income-generating skills and address their financial challenges.

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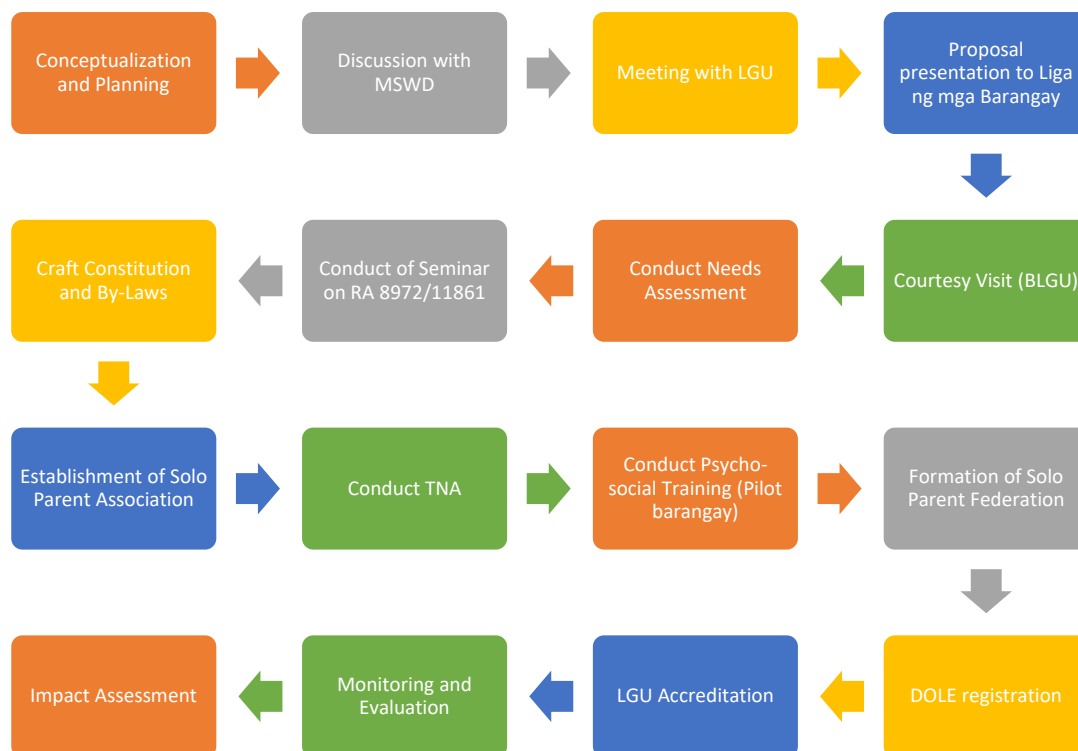




Methodology

After careful deliberation, the project proponents initiated discussions with the Municipal Social Welfare and Development of Pontevedra, Capiz, to explore potential collaboration, leading to a well-thought-out plan for project implementation. Subsequently, meetings were held with the Hon. Mayor Henry Tumlos to outline planned activities, and the LGU Pontevedra appointed a dedicated focal person for Solo Parents to ensure comprehensive support for the project. The project's rationale was presented to the Liga ng mga Barangay, which yielded a positive response from Barangay Tacas, who volunteered to be the pilot barangay. The project team conducted courtesy visits to all barangays, collaborating with local government units to conduct needs assessments for Solo Parents. After conducting the needs assessment, the team proceeded with a seminar on RA 8972 (Solo Parent Welfare Act)/RA 11861 (Expanded Solo Parent Welfare Act). They helped craft the constitution and by-laws, established a solo parent association for each barangay, and conducted a Training Needs Assessment survey. Once all barangays completed the seminar orientation, the team assisted in establishing a solo parents federation and provided support for DOLE (Department of Labor and Employment) registration and LGU (Local Government Unit) accreditation.

Feedback will be noted for the improvement of the project. An impact assessment will be done after the project implementation.



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Duties and Responsibilities

CapSU Pontevedra

1. Conceptualize project proposal details and deliverables.
2. Suggest possible solutions to problems that may exist during the implementation of the program.
3. Conduct seminar orientation on RA 8972/RA 11861 with partner agencies.
4. Assist in the implementation of the project under the CapSU Pontevedra Extension Program.
5. Conduct consultative meetings, monitoring, and evaluation.

MSWD and B/LGU

1. Ensure the safety of the faculty, staff, and students of CapSU during the conduct of extension work.
2. In charge of the identification of the project recipients.
3. Provide local venues for meetings and activities.
4. Attend consultative meetings called for relative to the program as the need arises.
5. May offer certain funds or any form of goods as part of counterpart, if needed.
6. Assists CapSU Pontevedra in the monitoring and evaluation of the recipients.
7. Ensure full support and cooperation on the agreed terms of project implementation.

Beneficiaries

1. Ensure the safety of the faculty, staff, and students of CapSU during the conduct of extension work.
2. Abide with the policies, rules, and laws promulgated.
3. Attend consultative meetings called for relative to the program.
4. Ensure full support and cooperation on the agreed terms of project implementation.

Results of Interventions

The Project SPACE (Solo Parent Acknowledgement, Capacity Building, and Empowerment) has had a positive impact not only on the university and the local solo parent community in the municipality of Pontevedra but also on the project implementers. The seminar orientation played a crucial role in equipping them with knowledge about their rights, privileges, and responsibilities. The evaluation demonstrates a significant increase in their awareness of various aspects of the law and the program following the orientation.

They were delighted to discover the numerous benefits and entitlements available to them as part of their rights. The seminar orientation served as the foundation for their formal organization as an association and federation, complete with crafted constitutions and by-laws. Additionally, it led to their recognition as a prominent community group, achieved through the registration with the Department of Labor and Employment (DOLE) and accreditation with the Local Government Unit (LGU).

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Furthermore, the seminar orientation provided them with the opportunity to choose training programs that could help them increase their income, identified through the Training Needs Assessment.

Lessons Learned

Project SPACE provides several key lessons: Education empowers individuals by arming them with knowledge about their rights and responsibilities; raising awareness is vital for positive change in communities; formal organizations, such as associations and federations, play a pivotal role in representing specific group interests; legal recognition through DOLE registration and LGU accreditation amplifies a project's impact; and tailored solutions based on the Training Needs Assessment are crucial for success. In essence, these lessons underscore the potential for positive transformation through education, awareness, organized structures, legal recognition, and customized support in projects aimed at empowering marginalized communities, especially solo parents.

Recommendations

To empower marginalized communities, such as solo parents, it is recommended to prioritize education through tailored programs, promote awareness through effective information dissemination, establish formal organizations to represent group interests, seek legal recognition and support from relevant government bodies, and implement customized solutions based on the Training Needs Assessment to enhance their well-being and empowerment. The next phases of the project, which focus on improving their well-being and income augmentation, should be implemented.

Furthermore, it is recommended to replicate a similar project in other municipalities to empower this marginalized sector.

SUSTAINABILITY PLAN

To sustain the project, the following activities will be made:

ORGANIZATIONAL	FINANCIAL	COMMUNITY
- Follow visits to ensure that the project is yielding the desired benefits - Fundraising skills to raise funds from other agencies.	- Return of Investment on Livelihood Project - Link beneficiaries to other agencies to provide support - From members' contribution	Community-based mechanism (Cooperative/ Association)



Future Directions

ACTIVITIES	SCHEDULE OF ACTIVITIES													
	2022			2023				2024				2025		
	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Q1	Q2	
a. Conceptualization of the Program														
b. Meeting and Consultation with Partner Agencies, Stakeholders, and Beneficiaries:														
c. Conduct Training-Seminar on RA 8972/11861														
d. Organization of Association (for Single Parents) in every barangay														
e. Formulation of Constitution and By-Laws														
f. Skills and Needs Assessment														
g. Formation of Federation														
h. Training on drafting CBL and Parliamentary Procedures/Conduct of Meeting														
i. Registration to DOLE														
j. Application for Accreditation														
k. Conduct of Monitoring and Feedback														
l. Conduct Training-workshop on the well-being														
m. Conduct Training on Skills and Livelihood (TNA Based)														
n. Provision of Starter Kit														
o. Conduct of Regular Monitoring/ Feed backing														
p. Conduct of Impact Assessment														

The first quarter of 2024 was scheduled for monitoring, evaluation and assessment of the members. The data to be gathered will be the basis for modifications or possible adjustments on activities for the next implementation Phase.

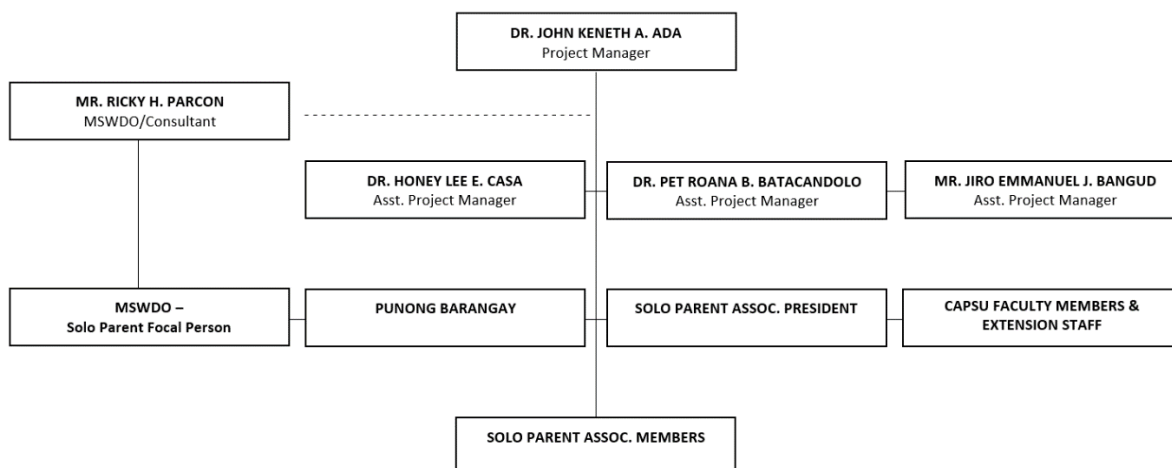
Literature Cited

P.R. Batacandolo (2019) Effectiveness of the Comprehensive Package of Social Development and Welfare Services for Solo Parents in the Province of Capiz



B. Project Management Team

The **Project Management Team** will be composed of the following members:



	NAME	OFFICE	DESIGNATION/ POSITION	SPECIALIZATION
	JOHN KENETH A. ADA	CapSU Pontevedra- College of Management	Extension Coordinator, Faculty Member	Business Planner/Financial Literacy and Management Lecturer
	RICKY H. PARCON	Local Government Unit of Pontevedra-MSWDO	Mun. Social Welfare and Development Officer	Social Worker, Community Organizer
	HONEY LEE E. CASA	CapSU Pontevedra – Administration Office/ College of Management	Campus Administrator/ University HR Director/ Faculty Member	Administrative Leadership/ Human Resource Management Practitioner
	PET ROANA B. BATACANDOLO	CapSU Pontevedra – College of Management / Administration Office	Human Resource and Mgt. Officer, Faculty Member	Financial/Human Resource Management Practitioner
	JIRO EMMANUEL J. BANGUD	CapSU Pontevedra – Extension Office	Extension Specialist I	Community Facilitator



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WHAT IS SOLO PARENT LEAVE FOR PARENTS?

Yes... as long as the child is living with him/her, dependent for support, unmarried, unemployed and below eighteen (18) years old, or eighteen (18) years old and above but is incapable of self-support and/or with physical/mental defect/disability.

WHAT ARE THE CONDITIONS FOR GRANTING PARENTAL LEAVE TO SOLO PARENTS?

The parental leave of seven (7) days shall be granted to any solo parent employee subject to the following conditions:

1. The solo parent must have rendered government service for at least one (1) year, whether continuous or broken, reckoned as of the time of the effectivity of the law on September 22, 2002, regardless of the status of employment.
2. The parental leave shall be availed of every year and shall not be convertible to cash. If not availed within the calendar year, said privilege shall be forfeited within the same year.
3. The parental leave shall be granted as a continuous or staggered basis, subject to the approval of the Administrator/Head Office. In this regard, the solo parent shall submit the application for parental leave at least one week prior to availing the solo parent leave, except on emergency basis.

WHAT ARE THE CONDITIONS FOR GRANTING PARENTAL LEAVE TO SOLO PARENTS?

1. *In the case of a solo parent, the following conditions shall apply:

- *Must be a personal misfortune of a child such as birth, marriage, graduation and other similar events.
- *Perform parental obligations such as enrollment and attendance in school programs, PTA meetings and the like.
- *Attend to medical, social, spiritual and recreational needs of the child.
- *Other similar circumstances necessary in the performance of parental duties and responsibilities, where physical presence of parent is required.
- *The head of the agency office concerned may determine whether granting of parental leave is proper or may conduct the necessary investigation to ascertain if grounds for termination and withdrawal of the privilege exist.

WHAT ARE THE CONDITIONS FOR GRANTING PARENTAL LEAVE TO SOLO PARENTS?

*There is no such provision in the law that there is maturity leave for Solo Parents. However, other laws can be applied.

Project SPACE (Solo Parent Acknowledgment, Capacity-Building, & Empowerment) an Extension Project of Capiz/Pontevedra College of Management in partnership with LGU Pontevedra

LGU PONTEVEDRA MSWD

MR. RICKY H. PARCON
OIC - MSWD
MS. DEMA B. BARROS
FOCAL PERSON - SOLO PARENT
CELL NO. 091-710-3530

CAPSU PONTEVEDRA Extension Department

DR. HONEY LEE E. CESA
Campus Administrator
DR. ABELARDO Y. BERMEJO JR.
Extension Chairman
CELL NO. 095-087-21328

Highlights of Republic Act 8972: SOLO PARENT'S WELFARE ACT OF 2000



BY:
DR. PET ROANA B. BATACANDOLO
DR. JOHN KENNETH A. ADA
MR. JIRO EMMANUEL J. BANGUD

Republic Act 8972 (SOLO PARENT'S WELFARE ACT OF 2000)

WHAT IS SOLO PARENT'S WELFARE ACT?

RA 8972 of the Solo Parent's Welfare Act provides for benefits and privileges to Solo Parents and their children. It aims to develop a comprehensive package of social development and welfare services for solo parents and their children to be carried out by the Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD), as the lead agency, various government agencies including NSD and other related NSD's.

WHEN DID RA 8972 TAKE EFFECT?

RA 8972 was signed into a law on November 7, 2000 and took effect on November 20, 2002. Its implementing rules and regulations (IRR) was approved in April 2003.

WHO ARE CONSIDERED AS SOLO PARENTS?

A solo parent is any individual who falls under any of the following categories:

1. A person who gives birth as a result of rape and other crimes against chastity even with out final conviction of the offender, provided that the mother keeps and rears the child.
2. Parent left solo or alone with the responsibility of parenthood due to the following circumstances:
 - *Due to death of the spouse.
 - *Spouse detained or in serving sentence for criminal conviction for at least one (1) year.
 - *Physical and/or mental incapacity of spouse as certified by a public medical practitioner.
 - *Legal separation or de facto separation from spouse for at least one (1) year, as long as he/she is entrusted with the custody of the children.
 - *Declaration of nullity of marriage as decreed by a court or by a church as long as he/she is entrusted with the custody of the children.
3. Unmarried mother/father who has preferred to keep and rear his/her child(ren) instead of having them care for or give them up to a welfare institution.
4. Any other person who can provide parental care and support to a child or children.
5. Any family member who assumes the responsibility of head of family as a result of the death, abandonment, disappearance or prolonged absence of the parents or solo parent.

WHAT ARE THE CONDITIONS FOR THE TERMINATION OF THE PRIVILEGES OF A SOLO PARENT?

A change in the status or circumstances of the parent claiming benefits under the act, such that he/she is no longer eligible with responsibility of parenthood, shall terminate his/her eligibility for benefits such as change in the status of marriage, the concerned parent is no longer left alone with the responsibility of parenthood etc.

WHAT IS THE PACKAGE OF SERVICES FOR SOLO PARENTS?

The comprehensive package of programs/services for solo parents includes livelihood, self-employment and skills development, employment related benefits, psychosocial, educational, health and housing services.

WHAT ARE THE CRITERIA FOR SUPPORT?

Any solo parents whose income in the place of domicile falls below the poverty threshold as set by the National Economic and Development Authority (NEDA) and subject to the assessment of the CSWD worker in the area shall be eligible for assistance. A solo parent can directly inquire from the following agencies for their services:

1. Health Services (DOH)
2. Educational Services (CHED, TESDA)
3. Housing (DBAL)
4. Parental Leave (Employee, DOL, CSC) Solo parent whose income above the poverty threshold shall enjoy only such limited benefits as flexible work schedule, parental leave and other can be determined by CSWD.

WHAT ARE THE STEPS TO AVAIL OF THE PACKAGE OF SERVICES?

A solo parent shall apply for a Solo Parent ID from the Chief Municipal Social Welfare and Development Office. Once the C/MWD Office issues the Solo Parent ID, a solo parent can apply for services he/she needs from CHED/DOH or to specific agencies providing such assistance services.

WHAT ARE THE REQUIREMENTS IN SECURING A SOLOPARENT ID?

1. Brgy. Certificate residency in the area.
2. Documents/evidence that the applicant is a solo parent (e.g. death certificate of spouse, declaration of nullity of marriage, medical certificate of incapacitation).
3. Income Tax Return (ITR) or certification from the barangay/municipal treasurer.

WHAT DOCUMENT/PROOF WILL A SOLO PARENT PRESENT IF HE/SHE HAS A CHILD OR IS DE FACTO SEPARATED FROM HIS/HER HUSBAND/WIFE?

A certificate issued by Brgy. Captain indicating the circumstances and proof being a solo parent.

IS A SOLO PARENT ELIGIBLE TO APPLY FOR AN ID TO BE SECURED RIGHT AWAY?

No. The social worker has to complete the assessment/evaluation of the solo parent situation. The ID will be issued after 30 days from filing the validity of the ID is one year and renewable.

WHAT IS PARENTAL LEAVE?

Parental leave refers to leave benefits granted to a solo parent to enable the said parent to perform parental duties and responsibilities when physical presence is required under Civil Service Commission (CSC) Memorandum Circular No. 18, Series 2004.

IS PARENTAL LEAVE RETROACTIVE SINCE THE LAW TOOK EFFECT LAST NOVEMBER 2000?

No. Parental leave is non-cumulative and can be availed only during the current year. Further it can only be availed after the issuance of the Solo Parent ID.

IS THE 7-DAY PARENTAL LEAVE IN ADDITION TO THE EXISTING 3-DAY SPECIAL LEAVE PRIVILEGE?

The law clearly indicates that the granting of the 7-day parental leave is on top of the 3-day special leave and other mandatory leave benefits.



**Brgy. Hipona and Brgy. Yatingan
Solo Parent Association**



**Brgy. Tabuc, Brgy. Ilawod and
Brgy. Haya Solo Parent
Association**



**Brgy. Rizal Solo Parent
Association**



**Brgy. Cabugao and Brgy. Gabuc
Solo Parent Association**



**Brgy. Sublangon, Brgy. Agdalipe,
Brgy. Guba and Brgy.
Linampongan Solo Parent
Association**



**Brgy. Malag-it and Brgy. Solo
Solo Parent Association**



**Brgy. Banate, Brgy. Intongcan
and Brgy. Lantangan Solo
Parent Association**



**Brgy. Aghanog and Brgy.
Bantigue Solo Parent
Association**



**Brgy. Ameligan Solo Parent
Association**



**Solo Parent Federation of
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MOA signed by CAPSU and LGU
Pontevedra.



Meeting with LGU.



Courtesy visit and Meeting with MSWD.



Presentation of the proposal to the Liga
ng mga Barangay.

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Consultation Meeting with Solo Parents and BLGU



Training Need Assessment

